Curriculum Vitae (Dr. YINGQI JING)

Name: Yingqi Jing
Gender: Male
Hometown: Nanjing, P. R. China
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Education

2016/10 - 2021/2 PhD in Comparative Linguistics
Department of Comparative Language Science, University of Zurich
Dissertation: Syntactic Harmony, Flexibility and Change in Language Use
Supervisors: Balthasar Bickel & Paul Widmer

2013/9 - 2016/3 MA in Foreign Linguistics and Applied Linguistics
School of International Studies, Zhejiang University
Dissertation: Harmonic Head Ordering and Language Classification Optimization
Supervisor: Haitao Liu

2009/9 - 2013/6 BA in English, with Honors
College of Foreign Languages, Guizhou University
Dissertation: Study on Cognitive Models of Metalinguistic Negation
Supervisor: Xianmo Zeng

Employment

2025/11 - present Assistant Professor
Institute of Modern Languages and Linguistics, Fudan University, China

2021/9 - 2025/10 Visiting researcher
Department of Linguistics and Philology, Uppsala University, Sweden
Advisors: Michael Dunn & Joakim Nivre

2024/11 - 2025/10 Postdoc researcher
Department of Linguistics, University of Geneva, Switzerland
Advisor: Paola Merlo

2024/4 - 2024/7 Postdoc researcher
Department of Archaeology, University of Turku, Finland
Advisor: Outi Vesakoski

2024/1 - 2024/3 Postdoc researcher
Department of Finnish, Finno-Ugrian and Scandinavian Studies, University of Helsinki, Finland
Advisor: Olesya Khanina

2021/3 - 2021/8 Postdoc researcher
Department of Biology, University of Turku, Finland
Advisor: Outi Vesakoski

2017/1 - 2021/2 Research assistant
Department of Comparative Language Science, University of Zurich, Switzerland
Advisor: Balthasar Bickel

2018/10 - 2019/2 Research assistant
Department of Comparative Language Science, University of Zurich, Switzerland
Advisor: Paul Widmer

Research grants

2024/11 - 2025/11 Project title: Disentangling Function and Diachrony in Syntactic Harmony
Grant: Swiss National Science Foundation Postdoc Mobility return grant (# P5R5PH_222133)
Amount: 107, 500 CHF

2021/8 - 2023/12 Project title: Bridging the gap between word order typology and universal dependency parsing
Grant: Swiss National Science Foundation Postdoc Mobility grant (# P500PH_202882)
Amount: 143, 092 CHF

2018/9 - 2019/9 Project title: Perspectives on Word Order Evolution: Reconstruction, Typology, and Processing (with Hiram Ring, Sebastian Sauppe & Wei Lee)
Grant: Graduate Campus Grant, University of Zurich (# 2018_Q1_G_002)
Amount: 6, 000 CHF

2016/10 - 2020/10 Project title: Word Order Universals: Challenge from Evolutionary Linguistics
Grant: Chinese Government Scholarship (# 201606320224)
Amount: 100, 800 CHF

Teaching

2026/3 - 2026/6 Quantitative Methods in Linguistics, Fudan University
2017/3 - 2017/7 Tutor for the course of Quantitative Methods in Linguistics by Balthasar Bickel
2022/4 Teaching course of R Programming and Visualization (with Michael Dunn)
10th International Seasonal School in Finno-Ugric Studies, Tartu, April 5th - 6th, 2022

Scientific reviewing activities

Ad-hoc reviewer for *Linguistics*, *Linguistic Typology*, *Cognitive Science*, *Open Mind*, *Linguistics Vanguard*, *Language and Cognition*, *Poznan Studies in Contemporary Linguistics*, *Journal of Language Evolution*, *EVOLANG*

Organization of conferences & workshop

2018/11 Workshop of Word Order Evolution
Institution: University of Zurich

Natural languages

Mandarin Chinese (native); English (fluent); German (intermediate); Cantonese (intermediate); Swedish (Elementary)

Programming skills

R (advanced); Python (advanced); stan (advanced); Julia (intermediate); JavaScript (intermediate); c++ (intermediate); SQL (intermediate)

Research output

(1) Current projects

1. **Jing, Yingqi**, Miina Norvik, Outi Vesakoski & Michael Dunn. 2024. Phylogenetic multilevel models reveal a simplicity bias in Uralic (ongoing).

2. **Jing, Yingqi**, Valentin Gusev,Yuri Koryakov, Maria Amelina & Olesya Khanina. 2026. Quantitative analysis of the diversification of Northern Samoyedic languages: contrasting linguistic domains. *Language Dynamics and Change* (under review).

3. **Jing, Yingqi**. 2026. Modeling correlated evolution of discrete characters: a global multilevel phylogenetic approach. *Linguistic Typology* (under revision).

4. **Jing, Yingqi**, Joakim Nivre & Michael Dunn. 2026. Syntactic change is largely shaped by neutral drift. *Language* (3rd round review).

(2) Publications in peer-reviewed scientific journals

1. **Jing, Yingqi**, Joakim Nivre & Michael Dunn. 2026. Multilevel phylogenetic inference of syntactic harmony. *Linguistics Vanguard* (Online).

2. **Jing, Yingqi**, Paul Widmer & Balthasar Bickel. 2023. Word Order Evolves at Similar Rates in Main and Subordinate Clauses: Corpus-based Evidence from Indo-European. *Diachronica*, 40(4), pp. 532-556.

3. Miina Norvik, **Yingqi Jing**, Michael Dunn, Robert Forkel, Terhi Honkola, Gerson Klumpp, Richard Kowalik, Helle Metslang, Karl Pajusalu, Minerva Piha, Eva Saar, Sirkka Saarinen & Outi Vesakoski. 2022. Uralic typology in the light of a new comprehensive dataset. *Journal of Uralic Linguistics*, 1, pp. 4-42.

4. **Jing, Yingqi**, Damian Blasi & Balthasar Bickel. 2022. Dependency Length Minimization and its Limits: a Possible Role for a Probabilistic Version of the Final-Over-Final Condition. *Language*, 98(3), pp. 397-418.

5. **Jing, Yingqi**, Miina Norvik, Outi Vesakoski, Michael Dunn. 2022. Phylogenetic multilevel models reveal a simplicity bias in Uralic. In *The evolution of language: Proceedings of the Joint Conference on Language Evolution (JCoLE)*. Nijmegen. ed. by A. Ravignani, R. Asano, D. Valente, F. Ferretti, S. Hartmann, M. Hayashi, Y. Jadoul, M. Martins, Y. Oseki, E. D. Rodrigues, O. Vasileva, and S. Wacewicz, pp. 357–360. Joint Conference on Language Evolution (JCoLE).

6. **Jing, Yingqi**, Paul Widmer & Balthasar Bickel. 2021. Word Order Variation is Partially Constrained by Syntactic Complexity. *Cognitive Science*, 45, e13056.

7. **Jing, Yingqi**, 2017. Coevolution of dependency distance, hierarchical structure and word order: Comment on "Dependency distance: a new perspective on syntactic patterns in natural languages" by Haitao Liu et al. *Physics of Life Reviews*, 21, pp. 228-229.

8. Liu, Haitao & **Yingqi Jing**, 2016. Quantitative Analysis of English Hierarchical Structure. *Journal of Foreign Languages*, 6, pp. 2-11.

(3) Peer-reviewed books/monograph

1. **Jing, Yingqi** & Haitao Liu, 2017. Dependency Distance Motifs in 21 Indo-European Languages. In: Haitao Liu & Junying Liang (eds.). Motifs in Language and Text. Berlin/Boston: Mouton de Gruyter. pp. 133-150.

(4) Peer-reviewed conference proceedings

1. **Jing, Yingqi** & Haitao Liu, 2015. Mean Hierarchical Distance: Augmenting Mean Dependency Distance. In: Proceedings of the Third International Conference on Dependency Linguistics (Depling 2015), Uppsala, Sweden, August 24-26, pp. 161-170.

(5) Contributions to conferences (oral presentation or poster)

2025/10 **Yingqi Jing**. Multilevel phylogenetic correlated evolution model. Talk at the 8th Quantitative Linguistics Seminar, Zhejiang Normal University, China.

2025/9 **Yingqi Jing**. Multilevel phylogenetic modeling of correlated evolution with lineage-specific variation. Talk at the WoGEL workshop, Uppsala University, Sweden.

2024/12 **Yingqi Jing**, Joakim Nivre, Robert Östling, and Michael Dunn. Multilevel phylogenetic inference of syntactic harmony. Talk at the 15th International Conference of the Association for Linguistic Typology, Nanyang Technological University, Singapore.

2024/05 **Yingqi Jing**, Joakim Nivre, and Michael Dunn. Multilevel phylogenetic inference of harmony in Indo-European. Talk at the 15th International Conference on the Evolution of Language, University of Wisconsin–Madison, Madison, USA.

2023/11 **Yingqi Jing**, Joakim Nivre, and Michael Dunn. Multilevel phylogenetic inference of harmony in Indo-European. Poster at the Crosslinguistic Perspectives on Processing and Learning (X-PPL), University of Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland.

2023/08 Outi Vesakoski, Mervi de Heer, Michael Dunn, John Huisman, **Yingqi Jing**, Miina Norvik and Tiago Tresoldi. Vertical and horizontal evolution of the Uralic language family and its relation to genetic and cultural history. Talk at the 56th Annual Meeting of the Societas Linguistica Europaea (SLE), National and Kapodistrian University of Athens, Athens, Greece.

2023/06 **Yingqi Jing**, Joakim Nivre, and Michael Dunn. Multilevel phylogenetic model shows no evidence for dependency locality in Indo-European. Talk at the 12th International Quantitative Linguistics Conference (QUALICO), University of Lausanne, Lausanne, Switzerland.

2022/12 **Yingqi Jing**, Miina Norvik, Outi Vesakoski and Michael Dunn. Phylogenetic multilevel models reveal a simplicity bias in Uralic. Talk at the 14th Conference of the Association for Linguistic Typology (ALT), University of Texas at Austin, Texas, USA.

2022/12 **Yingqi Jing**, Joakim Nivre, and Michael Dunn. Phylogenetic evidence against dependency locality in Indo-European. Talk at the 14th Conference of the Association for Linguistic Typology (ALT), University of Texas at Austin, Texas, USA.

2022/9 **Yingqi Jing**, Miina Norvik, Outi Vesakoski and Michael Dunn. Phylogenetic multilevel models reveal a simplicity bias in Uralic. Poster at the Joint Conference on Language Evolution (Evolang, Protolang and Evolinguistics), Kanazawa, Japan.

2022/8 Miina Norvik, **Yingqi Jing**, Michael Dunn, Helle Metslang, Karl Pajusalu and Outi Vesakoski. Uralic typology in the light of a new comprehensive dataset. Talk at the 13th International Congress for Finno-Ugric Studies, University of Vienna, Austria.

2021/10 **Yingqi Jing**. A quantitative investigation of Uralic linguistic typology. Talk at the Workshop on Uralic Typology, University of Tartu, Estonia.

2021/6 Miina Norvik & **Yingqi Jing**. Uralic Typological Database. Talk at the Workshop of Uralic Historical Atlas, University of Turku, Finland.

2021/3 **Yingqi Jing**. Detecting syntactic regularities and change: a corpus-based evolutionary approach. Invited talk at University of Turku, Finland.

2020/4 **Yingqi Jing**, Paul Widmer and Balthasar Bickel. Evolutionary rates and directions of word order change across main and subordinate clauses in Indo-European. Talk at the 13th International Conference on Language Evolution (EvoLang), Vrije Universiteit Brussel, Brussels, Belgium.

2019/9 **Yingqi Jing**, Paul Widmer and Balthasar Bickel. Challenging the penthouse: word order variation in main vs subordinate clauses. Talk at the 13th Conference of the Association for Linguistic Typology (ALT), University of Pavia, Pavia, Italy.

2019/9 Manuel Widmer, Erik van Gijn, Alena Witzlack-Makarevich, Erika Just, **Yingqi Jing** & Nico Neureiter. On the evolution of so-called hierarchical person-marking systems in Tupian and Sino-Tibetan. Talk at the 13th Conference of the Association for Linguistic Typology (ALT), University of Pavia, Pavia, Italy.

2019/7 **Yingqi Jing**, Paul Widmer & Balthasar Bickel. Evolutionary rates and directions of word order change across main and subordinate clauses in Indo-European. Talk at the 24th International Conference on Historical Linguistics (ICHL), Australian National University, Canberra, Australia.

2018/11 **Jing Yingqi**. Harmony, locality and dependency direction in syntax. Talk at the Workshop of Perspectives on Word Order Evolution: Reconstruction, Typology, and Processing, University of Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland.

2018/11 André Müller & **Jing Yingqi**. Evolutionary rates and directions of noun modifiers in Sino-Tibetan languages. Talk at the Workshop of Perspectives on Word Order Evolution: Reconstruction, Typology, and Processing, University of Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland.

2018/8 **Yingqi Jing**. Diachronic evidence of harmonic word order: A complex network approach. Talk at the 51st Annual Meeting of the Societas Linguistica Europaea (SLE), University of Tallinn, Tallinn, Estonia.

2018/4 **Yingqi Jing**, Damian Blasi & Balthasar Bickel. Harmony and dendrophilia in syntax. Talk at the 12th International Conference on Language Evolution (EvoLang), Nicolas Copernicus University, Toruń, Poland.

2017/12 **Yingqi Jing**, Damian Blasi & Balthasar Bickel. Harmony and dendrophilia in syntax. Talk at the 12th Conference of the Association for Linguistics Typology (ALT), Australian National University, Canberra, Australia.

2017/9 **Yingqi Jing**. Exploring harmonic word order: a complex network perspective. Talk at the Workshop of Perspectives on word order, University of Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland.

(6) Outreach activities

2023/3 Stochastic Differential Equations with YUIMA, Linköping University, Sweden.

2022/10 Attend the StanConnect: Stan Through Space and Time.

2021/4 Attend the Copenhagen Phylolinguistics Workshop, University of Copenhagen, Denmark.

2020/8 Attend the Julia SHARCNET Summer School on Advanced Research Computing.

2019/9 Attend Summer School on Language Universals and Language Diversity in an Evolutionary Perspective, Lake Como, Italy.

2018/9 Attend the 2nd Summer School on Statistical Methods for Linguistics and Psychology (SMLP), University of Potsdam, Potsdam, Germany.

2017/11 Attend the 3rd Summer School of the ARC Centre of Excellence for the Dynamics of Language, Australian National University, Canberra, Australia.

2017/5 Attend the Quantitative Methods - Spring School in Max Planck Institute for the Science of Human History (MPI-SHH) in Jena.